

# EcoLoop — Problem & Market Statement

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## The Problem

Egypt generates approximately 76,000 tons of municipal solid waste every single day. Less than 15% of that is formally recycled. The rest is either landfilled, burned, or lost to informal collection networks that operate outside any data or accountability system.

The gap is not a lack of recyclable material — it is a structural disconnect between three actors who never effectively communicate: households that generate waste, collection services that move it, and recycling companies that need it sorted and consistent.

Households don't separate waste at source because they see no direct benefit from doing so, have no reliable infrastructure to receive what they separate, and receive no guidance on how to do it correctly. Even when the will exists, the system around them isn't built to receive it.

## The Core Insight

The problem is behavioral and infrastructural — not material. Egypt doesn't lack recyclable waste. It lacks a coordination layer that makes recycling the path of least resistance rather than the path of most effort.

## The Market

- **76,600 tons** of municipal waste generated daily in Egypt (CAPMAS)
- **~28 million tons** annually, growing with urbanization and population growth
- Formal recycling rate below **15%** nationally
- Informal sector (Zabbaleen network) handles an estimated **40–60%** of Cairo's recyclables — entirely outside formal data systems
- Egypt's waste management market projected to grow significantly through 2030 driven by regulatory pressure and private sector entry

## Who Has This Problem Most Acutely

**Primary:** Urban residential households and compounds in mid-to-large Egyptian cities — specifically property management companies overseeing 50+ units, where waste volume is high and liability for compliance is concentrated in one decision-maker.

**Secondary:** Recycling companies operating in Egypt that currently rely on inconsistent informal supply chains and have no visibility into collection quality or volume in advance.

## Why Now

Egypt's 2050 National Climate Strategy, combined with increasing municipal pressure on waste management compliance, is creating regulatory tailwinds that didn't exist three years ago. The market is moving toward formalization — EcoLoop is designed to be the coordination infrastructure that makes that transition possible.